

Sensory & perception mapping

What this tool produces · *Multisensory maps and datasets detailing the acoustic quality (soundscapes), olfactory environment (smellscales), and emotional responses attached to specific urban zones.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Sensory & perception mapping*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Validating the intimate, bodily experience of the city; recognizing that the smell of a local market or the sound of a public square is just as critical to urban identity as its architecture.

Evidence we produce

Multisensory maps and datasets detailing the acoustic quality (soundscapes), olfactory environment (smellscape), and emotional responses attached to specific urban zones.

Duration & Material

Duration · 1 month of field walks and technical data collection, 1 month of mapping

Material · Printed base maps, mobile survey apps, sound level meters (SPL), field audio recorders

Reference case

The "Multimodal Hong Kong" project systematically documents the soundscapes and smellscape of culturally significant sites (like wet markets and temples). By capturing 'smellprints' (via air sampling) and ambisonic audio alongside citizen evaluations, the project proves that intangible sensory elements are fundamental to understanding and preserving the perceived quality of an urban place.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Sensory grid · sight · sound · smell · touch · taste

Duration
1 month of field walks and technical data collection, 1...

Sight

colours, light, sky, vistas

+

=

-

#1

#2

#3

#4

#5

#6

Sound

voices, bells, traffic, silence

+

=

-

#1

#2

#3

#4

#5

#6

Smell

food, smoke, plants, drains

+

=

-

#1

#2

#3

#4

#5

#6

Touch

textures, wind, temperature

+

=

-

#1

#2

#3

#4

#5

#6

Taste

street food, water, air

+

=

-

#1

#2

#3

#4

#5

#6

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.